

Tom de Gay

tomdegay.com →
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Product design leader
14 years in hands-on product design
Design for AI and automation

Profile

Product design leader specialising in AI, automation and complex domains. With a background in wayfinding, I make technically ambitious systems clear and usable. A founding-team member at Quantemplate, I remain hands-on across strategy, research, interaction design and delivery.

Experience

Quantemplate

Enterprise data platform for sharing, transforming, validating and automating complex commercial data in a no-code environment. Trusted by AXA, Aegon, Chubb, Everest, Somo and more, supporting 17,000 pipeline runs and outputting 3.4 billion rows annually.

Head of Design | Product Leadership

2021–Present

Expanded remit into product leadership, shaping strategy and direction while leading the end-to-end product experience as an individual contributor.

- Designed a semantic layer that improved usability and performance across the product, including a fourfold improvement in the accuracy of column-mapping suggestions.
- Proposed and delivered Feeds, a strategic initiative connecting organisations to share data and build network intelligence.
- Designed the automation framework and ‘Robot User’ concept, laying the groundwork for agentic capabilities.
- Worked directly with customers on implementations and product improvements. Mature implementations now average just three support requests per year.
- Introduced AI prototyping tools into the design process, shortening product feedback loops.
- Supported enterprise procurement through technical and design RFP responses.

Head of Design

2016–21

Led design through the company’s pivot to data transformation, from seed through Series A and a period of 10x ARR growth.

- Designed the data transformation product experience across 30+ distinct functions.
- Established ease of use as a key differentiator for blue-chip insurance clients.
- Hired and managed four people across design and marketing.
- Extended an externally developed brand identity and rolled it out across all channels.
- Migrated design tooling and established a scalable engineering-friendly design system.
- Created the product knowledge base (100+ articles), allowing users to self-serve.

Founding Product Designer

2012–16

Joined a four-person team as first designer, exploring fintech and insurtech ideas.

- Designed the product experience and in-product brand, making complex analytics accessible through drag-and-drop dashboards, multi-page reports and data visualisation. Established ease of use and a distinctive product identity as early differentiators.
- Joined Techstars’ first London cohort in 2013 and subsequently secured seed funding.

Experience

Placefield | Independent design consultancy

2012–Present

Placefield is my independent design practice for selected side-projects, providing space to explore new tools and ideas. Digital projects include:

- Image Insight (2026). Digital coaching tool. Turned a 'clunky' MVP into an elegant, low-friction experience with positive user feedback. Currently in beta testing in two schools.
- Zonefully (2021). A new model for planning recurring activities around long-term goals. Translated the founder's model into a coherent interface, bringing the concept from idea to a resolved and functioning v1.

Avanti Architects | Wayfinding designer

2005–12

- Design lead on wayfinding projects spanning strategy, information design and environmental graphics.
- Projects included audit, strategy, planning and execution for complex sites such as Bristol Southmead Hospital (600k visitors/year), Pontefract Hospital (100k visitors/year) and Haggerston School (1,100 pupils).
- Wayfinding principles continue to underpin my digital product practice today.

Leeds Beckett University | Visiting Lecturer

2005–16

- Teaching, mentoring and opening up possibilities for around 300 final-year students in Graphic Design, Fine Art and contemporary Art Practices.

Education

MA Communication Design | Distinction

2003–05 | Central Saint Martins College of Art & Design

Specialised in information design and wayfinding, exploring how design helps people understand and navigate complex environments.

BA (Hons) Graphic Arts and Design | First Class

2000–03 | Leeds Beckett University

Additional Roles

Design for Complexity Meetup | Co-Founder

2018–20

Meetup for people involved in the design of complex products. Grew membership to 500 and ran several in-person events with insightful talks from industry leaders.

Isokon Gallery | Trustee | Design Lead

2014–Present

Co-founded and designed award-winning micro museum in London, dedicated to the story of modernist architecture, design and urban living. 50k visitors and counting.

Expertise

Skills

Product design · Interaction design · Information architecture · Prototyping · Design systems · Data visualisation · Enterprise UX · Zero-to-one

Domains

Design for AI · Complex systems · Enterprise SaaS · Data products · Workflow automation · Analytics · Insurance technology

Tools

Claude Code · Figma · Sketch · Lovable · After Effects · Adobe Creative Suite · Miro · GitHub · HTML/CSS